



SUPARNA MITRA
55, CEO, WATCHES & WEARABLES DIVISION, TITAN COMPANY

MAKING GOOD TIME

If the story of the past three years has centred around survival, 2023 has purely been about growing for Suparna Mitra. Defying the challenges of Covid-19, the division under Mitra's watch has emerged as one of the fastest growing segments for Titan Company. Its watches and wearables division crossed the ₹5,000-crore mark in annual turnover in FY23. "To increase focus, we divided the business into three segments... And all our engines are firing," she says. Further, Mitra plans to turn the division into a ₹10,000-crore per year business by 2026. To that end, the company added 150 stores in the last year. And the momentum will continue, she says. **BT**

— BY ARNAB DUTTA



SUMAN MISHRA
45, MD & CEO, MAHINDRA LAST MILE MOBILITY LIMITED

Green Vanguard

THE WORLD TODAY, especially in the ever-changing realm of technology, demands the ability to embrace the unpredictable and navigate with agility. Leaders like Suman Mishra, who operate in the male-dominated world of automotive en-

gineering, are born with it. For her, leading Mahindra Last Mile Mobility (LMM) has underscored the importance of humility and lifelong learning.

Under her leadership, the company saw a huge year-on-year growth in FY23, with sales volumes

increasing 2.5x and production capacity 3x. This year, she also spearheaded a significant deal securing a ₹600-crore investment from the International Finance Corporation (IFC), with the latter valuing Mahindra LMM at \$740 million. "This investment is IFC's first in an Indian EV manufacturer and will help boost electric three-wheelers and small commercial vehicle production, thus advancing the auto industry's shift from fossil fuels to electric vehicles," says Mishra. The deal highlighted her commitment to decarbonising transport and achieving India's climate goals.

She feels the growing demand for EVs presents an opportunity to attract women from the tech sector and is a great motivator to increase female participation in auto. "It's important to implement policies that support work-life balance, such as extended maternity leave, childcare facilities, and flexible work arrangements," she says. Mishra adds that targeted recruitment helps. "Proactively seek out qualified women for open positions. Employ recruitment strategies that reach a wider pool of female candidates. At Mahindra, while we do not have any targets, we look at all open positions and try to maximise women's participation in the interview process," she adds. **BT**

— BY PRERNA LIDHOO

WHAT KEEPS ME GOING

Learning and solving complex problems give me purpose and drive

LIFE LESSONS LEARNT ON THE JOB

Be resilient through uncertainty